

One of the biggest riverside plants, the **giant rhubarb**, grows 8 ft (2.5 m) tall and 13 ft (4 m) wide. Not much smaller, the **white skunk cabbage** grows huge cabbagelike leaves. Both plants die away in winter, shedding leaves that might otherwise become caught up in floodwater and uproot them. Plants such as the **marsh marigold**, **purple**

loosestrife, **water spearmint**, and **candelabra primrose** lie dormant in winter but grow fast in spring or summer. **Cattail**, **soft rush**, and **snowberry** have a different survival strategy. They are present all year long, and their tough leaves or stems can withstand swift floodwaters, so each year they grow even larger.

The brown, conelike structures at the end of this nonflowering plant's stems contain spores.

Stalks of horsetail were used by early American pioneers to scour **pots and pans**.

Soft rush

Rough horsetail

Tall spikes of delicate mauve flowers blossom in late summer.

A cluster of bright red flowers grows on the side of the stem.

Purple loosestrife

In North America, these white berries are food for bighorn sheep and grizzly bears.

Common snowberry

Clusters of up to six flowers are borne on tall, sturdy stems.

Candelabra primrose

These leaves have a minty smell.

Water spearmint

White skunk cabbage

Large, white leaflike bracts attract flies to the smelly flower heads.